

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

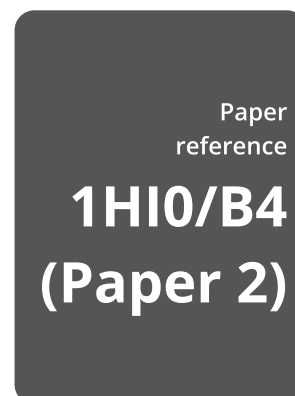
Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -
total time for **both** booklets)

History

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,
1558-88**



You must have:

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

- 1** (a) Describe one feature of Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government. (2)

- (b) Describe one feature of Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'. (2)

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

2 Explain why Elizabeth faced challenges at home and from abroad upon her accession in 1558. (12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- financial weaknesses
- the French threat

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)
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Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

- 3** 'Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne was the main cause of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- religious divisions
- the role of the nobility

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

- 4** 'The actions of Robert Dudley were the main reason for deteriorating relations with Spain in the years 1585–88.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- English direct involvement in the Netherlands
- commercial rivalry

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

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TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

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